

REPUBLIC OF UGANDA



RESEARCH, PLANNING AND INNOVATION CENTER RPIC COMMUNITY EMERGENCY FUND CONSTITUTION

A formal governance framework for solidarity, emergency support, financial accountability, and member welfare within the RPIC Community.

Prepared for adoption by the RPIC Community

Date of Adoption: _____

Venue: _____

PREAMBLE

Recognizing the importance of unity, solidarity, welfare, and timely support among members of the RPIC Community, and acknowledging the need for a transparent and accountable framework for managing welfare resources, this Constitution is hereby established to govern the RPIC Community Emergency Fund.

The Fund is intended to provide structured emergency assistance, promote responsible participation by members, and ensure that all contributions, decisions, and disbursements are administered fairly, prudently, and in the best interest of the community.

FUND SNAPSHOT

Name	RPIC Community Emergency Fund
Nature	A member-based emergency and welfare support fund
Primary Purpose	To provide timely and accountable support during approved emergencies affecting members
Governance Model	General Meeting, AGM, Executive Committee, and standing committees

ARTICLE 1: NAME, STATUS AND AREA OF OPERATION

1.1 Name

The association shall be known as the RPIC Community Emergency Fund, hereinafter referred to as “the Fund”.

1.2 Status

The Fund shall operate as a welfare and emergency support arrangement established by members of the RPIC Community for mutual assistance in times of need, subject to applicable law, institutional policy, and this Constitution.

1.3 Area of operation

The Fund shall operate primarily within the RPIC Community and may extend to members stationed or residing elsewhere, as may be determined by the Fund in accordance with this Constitution.

1.4 Office

The principal office of the Fund shall be at the RPIC Center or any other officially approved location communicated to members.

ARTICLE 2: VISION, MISSION, OBJECTIVES AND VALUES

2.1 Vision

To build a united, caring, and resilient RPIC Community with a reliable and well-governed emergency support system.

2.2 Mission

To mobilize and manage member contributions in order to provide timely, fair, and accountable financial support during emergencies affecting members and their immediate families.

2.3 General objective

To promote welfare, solidarity, and emergency financial support among members of the RPIC Community.

2.4 Specific objectives

The specific objectives of the Fund shall be to: (a) provide emergency financial assistance to eligible members; (b) build a sustainable emergency fund through regular contributions; (c) strengthen transparency, accountability, and record keeping; (d) provide orderly procedures for claims verification, approval, and disbursement; (e) promote unity, mutual care, and responsible member participation.

2.5 Guiding values

The Fund shall be guided by solidarity, integrity, transparency, accountability, fairness, confidentiality, discipline, teamwork, and respect for members.

ARTICLE 3: INTERPRETATION

3.1 Definitions

Unless the context otherwise requires: “AGM” means Annual General Meeting; “Executive Committee” means the governing leadership of the Fund; “member in good standing” means a member who is current on required contributions and not under suspension; “immediate family” means spouse, biological or legally dependent children, and biological parents unless otherwise resolved by members; “defaulter” means a member who fails to make required contributions within the prescribed period; “emergency” means an approved incident qualifying for support under this Constitution.

3.2 Interpretation authority

Any question regarding interpretation of this Constitution shall first be considered by the Executive Committee and, where necessary, determined by the General Meeting.

ARTICLE 4: MEMBERSHIP

4.1 Eligibility

Membership shall be open to members of the RPIC Community and to any additional category of persons formally approved by the General Meeting.

4.2 Admission

A person shall become a member upon expressing formal interest, completing the prescribed membership process, accepting this Constitution, paying any approved registration fee, and beginning regular contributions.

4.3 Membership register

The Secretary shall maintain an updated register containing names, contacts, dates of joining, and contribution status of members.

4.4 Rights of members

A member in good standing shall have the right to attend, speak, and vote at General Meetings; access approved reports and records of the Fund; benefit from the Fund in accordance with this Constitution; and elect or be elected to office, subject to eligibility requirements.

4.5 Obligations of members

Every member shall comply with this Constitution and lawful decisions of the Fund, pay contributions and approved fees on time, provide truthful information when making a claim, uphold unity and discipline, and protect the resources and reputation of the Fund.

ARTICLE 5: CESSATION, WITHDRAWAL AND DISCIPLINE OF MEMBERSHIP

5.1 Cessation of membership

Membership shall cease upon death, voluntary resignation in writing, expulsion in accordance with this Constitution, loss of eligibility, or prolonged inactivity or non-contribution as determined by the AGM.

5.2 Voluntary withdrawal

A member may withdraw by written notice. Contributions already made to the emergency pool shall not be refundable unless otherwise resolved by the AGM.

5.3 Defaulters

A member who falls into arrears shall be notified and given reasonable time to clear the outstanding balance. Continued default may lead to suspension of benefits, loss of voting rights, or further disciplinary action.

5.4 Discipline

Disciplinary action may be taken against any member who persistently defaults without cause, submits false claims, misuses Fund resources, or acts in a manner prejudicial to the unity, integrity, or objectives of the Fund.

5.5 Right to be heard

No member shall be disciplined or expelled without being notified of the allegations and being given an opportunity to respond.

ARTICLE 6: SOURCES OF FUNDS AND CONTRIBUTIONS

6.1 Sources of funds

The resources of the Fund shall derive from registration or entrance fees where approved, regular member contributions, special emergency contributions, donations, grants, and any other lawful source approved by the General Meeting.

6.2 Regular contributions

Each member shall make regular contributions at rates approved by the AGM or Special General Meeting.

6.3 Special contributions

Where an emergency requires collective mobilization, members may be required to make a special per-incident contribution approved under the procedures of the Fund.

6.4 Review of contribution rates

Contribution levels may be reviewed and revised by resolution of the AGM or a duly convened Special General Meeting.

6.5 Separate recording

Where members make personal savings or other voluntary deposits in addition to emergency contributions, such amounts shall be clearly recorded separately from the emergency pool.

ARTICLE 7: BENEFITS AND INCIDENTS COVERED

7.1 Eligible incidents

Subject to this Constitution and approved benefit schedules, the Fund may provide support in cases of severe illness, accidents, death of a member, death of a spouse, death of a biological child, death of a biological parent, and such other emergencies as may be approved by members.

7.2 Eligibility for benefit

A claim shall qualify for consideration only where the member is in good standing, the incident falls within an approved category, the matter is reported through the proper channel, and verification has been completed as required.

7.3 Conditions and limits

The AGM may approve schedules setting out categories of emergencies, documentary requirements, contribution triggers, ceilings of support, response timelines, and any limitations or exclusions applicable to claims.

7.4 Exclusions

No benefit shall be payable in respect of fraudulent claims, incidents falling outside approved categories, or claims submitted in bad faith.

ARTICLE 8: ORGANS OF THE FUND

8.1 Organs

The organs of the Fund shall be the General Meeting, the Annual General Meeting, the Executive Committee, and committees established under this Constitution.

8.2 General Meeting

The General Meeting shall be the supreme decision-making organ of the Fund and shall determine major policy matters, approve key resolutions, elect leaders, receive reports, and consider appeals and amendments.

8.3 AGM

The AGM shall be held once in every financial year to receive annual reports and financial statements, review operations, elect leaders where due, approve budgets and contribution revisions, and consider other matters placed before it.

8.4 Special General Meeting

A Special General Meeting may be convened by the Executive Committee or upon written request by a prescribed proportion of members, and shall transact only the business for which it is called.

ARTICLE 9: MEETINGS, NOTICE AND QUORUM

9.1 Types of meetings

The Fund may hold General Meetings, Annual General Meetings, Special General Meetings, Executive Committee meetings, and committee meetings.

9.2 Notice

Notice of meetings shall be issued by the Secretary through approved communication channels and shall state the date, venue or mode, time, and agenda.

9.3 Quorum

Unless otherwise resolved by the AGM, the quorum for a General Meeting or AGM shall be one-third of active members. Where quorum is not attained, the meeting shall be adjourned and reconvened in accordance with the notice.

9.4 Decision making

Decisions shall generally be made by majority vote of members present and entitled to vote, except where this Constitution requires a higher threshold.

9.5 Virtual meetings

Meetings may be conducted physically, virtually, or in hybrid form where circumstances so require, provided members are properly notified and can participate meaningfully.

ARTICLE 10: EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE AND OFFICERS

10.1 Composition

The Executive Committee shall consist of at least the Chairperson, Vice Chairperson, Secretary, Treasurer, Welfare Officer, Publicity or Communications Officer, and Auditor or Internal Accountability Officer.

10.2 Chairperson

The Chairperson shall provide overall leadership, preside over meetings, ensure implementation of decisions, supervise officers and committees, and authorize approved official actions on behalf of the Fund.

10.3 Vice Chairperson

The Vice Chairperson shall assist the Chairperson and perform the functions of the Chairperson in his or her absence.

10.4 Secretary

The Secretary shall issue notices, keep minutes and records, manage correspondence, maintain the membership register, and safeguard official documents of the Fund.

10.5 Treasurer

The Treasurer shall receive and account for contributions, keep financial records, prepare financial reports, support proper banking or mobile money controls, and present accounts to meetings.

10.6 Welfare Officer

The Welfare Officer shall coordinate welfare case reporting, support verification of emergencies, and advise the Fund on urgent member support needs.

10.7 Publicity or Communications Officer

The Publicity or Communications Officer shall manage official notices, member mobilization, and communication of approved Fund activities.

10.8 Auditor or Internal Accountability Officer

The Auditor or Internal Accountability Officer shall periodically review records, verify accountability, and submit findings to the appropriate meeting of the Fund.

ARTICLE 11: ELECTIONS, TERM OF OFFICE, VACANCIES AND REMOVAL

11.1 Elections

Leaders of the Fund shall be elected by members at the AGM or another duly constituted General Meeting in accordance with approved election procedures.

11.2 Term of office

The term of office for elected leaders shall be determined by the AGM and may be renewed subject to the rules of the Fund.

11.3 Vacancies

Where a vacancy arises in office, the Fund may fill it through an interim appointment or election in accordance with a resolution of the Executive Committee or General Meeting, as applicable.

11.4 Removal from office

An officer may be removed from office for gross misconduct, persistent failure to perform duties, abuse of office, financial impropriety, conflict of interest not disclosed, or conduct prejudicial to the Fund.

11.5 Due process

Before removal, the officer concerned shall be notified of the allegations and be given an opportunity to respond.

ARTICLE 12: COMMITTEES

12.1 Establishment

The Fund may establish standing or ad hoc committees as necessary for the efficient discharge of its work.

12.2 Standing committees

Without limiting the power of the Fund, standing committees may include a Welfare and Verification Committee, Finance and Accountability Committee, Conflict Resolution and Discipline Committee, and Mobilization or Events Committee.

12.3 Reporting

Committees shall report to the Executive Committee and, where necessary, to the General Meeting.

12.4 Powers of committees

Committees shall act only within the mandate assigned to them and shall not bind the Fund outside approved authority.

ARTICLE 13: FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT AND ACCOUNTABILITY

13.1 Financial controls

The Fund shall maintain proper financial controls and accurate records of contributions, arrears, withdrawals, disbursements, balances, beneficiaries, approvals, and supporting documentation.

13.2 Account operations

The Fund shall maintain an approved account or other authorized financial channel, and transactions shall be governed by signatory controls and accountability procedures approved by members.

13.3 Reporting

Monthly, quarterly, and annual financial reports may be prepared as appropriate, and annual financial statements shall be presented at the AGM.

13.4 Approval of withdrawals and disbursements

No withdrawal or disbursement shall be made without proper approval in accordance with the procedures of the Fund.

13.5 Audit and inspection

Financial records shall be open to audit or internal review, and members may inspect approved records in accordance with procedures set by the Fund.

13.6 Use of funds

All resources of the Fund shall be applied solely for lawful purposes consistent with this Constitution and approved resolutions.

ARTICLE 14: CLAIMS, VERIFICATION AND DISBURSEMENT PROCEDURE

14.1 Reporting of incidents

All incidents giving rise to a claim shall be reported to the Welfare Officer, Secretary, Chairperson, or any designated officer within a reasonable time.

14.2 Verification

The relevant officers or committee shall verify the incident through documents, witness confirmation, or any other reasonable means appropriate to the emergency.

14.3 Approval

Where a claim is found to be valid, the responsible organ of the Fund shall approve the support to be given in accordance with approved schedules and available resources.

14.4 Emergency action

In urgent cases, interim support may be authorized by the Executive Committee subject to subsequent reporting to members.

14.5 Record of payment

Every disbursement shall be recorded with the date, beneficiary, amount, reason, and approving authority.

ARTICLE 15: CONFLICT OF INTEREST, CONFIDENTIALITY AND ETHICS

15.1 Conflict of interest

Any officer or member participating in a decision in which he or she has a personal, financial, or family interest shall disclose that interest and shall not participate in that decision unless permitted under a lawful quorum arrangement.

15.2 Confidentiality

Leaders and members handling Fund matters shall maintain confidentiality in relation to personal, medical, family, and financial information obtained through Fund business, except where disclosure is necessary for lawful or approved purposes.

15.3 Ethical conduct

All officers and members shall act honestly, diligently, respectfully, and in the best interests of the Fund at all times.

ARTICLE 16: DISPUTE RESOLUTION AND APPEALS

16.1 Internal resolution

Any dispute arising under this Constitution shall first be referred to the Conflict Resolution and Discipline Committee or such other organ as the Fund may designate.

16.2 Appeals

A member aggrieved by a disciplinary or administrative decision may appeal to the General Meeting, whose decision shall be final unless otherwise provided by law.

16.3 Preservation of unity

In resolving disputes, the Fund shall promote fairness, mutual respect, and restoration of harmony where possible.

ARTICLE 17: AMENDMENT, TRANSITIONAL MATTERS AND DISSOLUTION

17.1 Amendment

This Constitution may be amended by a resolution of the AGM or a duly constituted General Meeting in accordance with the threshold approved by members.

17.2 Transitional arrangements

Upon adoption of this Constitution, the Fund may approve interim schedules, regulations, contribution rates, and office arrangements necessary to operationalize its provisions.

17.3 Dissolution

The Fund may only be dissolved by a special resolution of members at a duly convened meeting, and any remaining assets shall be dealt with in accordance with the resolution passed and any applicable law or institutional guidance.

SCHEDULES

The following schedules may be completed, revised, and adopted by resolution of members without requiring a full redraft of the Constitution, provided they remain consistent with its provisions.

Schedule A: Membership and Contribution Schedule

Item	Approved Amount / Rule
Registration fee	
Regular contribution	
Special per-incident contribution	
Arrears grace period	

Schedule B: Benefit Categories and Support Levels

Emergency Category	Approved Support / Procedure
Death of member	
Death of spouse	
Death of child	
Death of parent	
Severe illness / accident	
Other emergencies	

Schedule C: Authorized Signatories and Financial Controls

Control Item	Approved Position / Rule
Primary signatory	
Co-signatory	
Alternative signatory	
Approval threshold for emergency disbursement	

ADOPTION AND EXECUTION

This Constitution is adopted by the members of the RPIC Community Emergency Fund on the date indicated below and shall take effect in accordance with the resolution of adoption.

Date of Adoption	
Venue	
Chairperson	
Secretary	

Official Seal / Stamp (where applicable)